5.1.2 Classification of residential building

Detached house	*Semi-detached house*	*Row of houses*	*Apartments or flats*	*Skyscrapers*
This is an independent house surrounded by its own land on all the sides.	A common boundary wall to form a structural barrier and divides an independent plot into two units. This helps in achieving economy by sharing expenses on amenities such as water lines, drainage lines, and electric cables.	This is preferred for low-income group of families. These rows of houses, have a common wall between two houses, with minimum requirements such as living room, and kitchen.	This consists of three to seven storeys and each floor or storey may accommodate two or four tenements. The land and other amenities are shared by all the occupants.	These are multi-storeyed building. This is common in big cities where the price of the land is very high.

Types of residential buildings

5.1.3 Factors affecting choice of house

The following points should be kept in mind while looking out for a house.

- **Physiological needs**: The house should have adequate ventilation and proper orientation so that there is proper temperature balance, adequate fresh air circulation and light.
- **Psychological needs**: The house should provide privacy and safety.
- **Family size**: A large family with more than six members have to go for a larger house than a small family with four members.
- **Family type:** Families can be classified as nuclear, extended or joint families. The size of the house will vary according to the type of family.
- **Stage of family life cycle:** The stage in which the family is should be considered. A family in the expanding stage will need a larger house than a family in the beginning or contracting stage.
- **Permanence of residence:** There are two types of family in this regard.
  1. **Transient family** - which has to move from place to place, because of occupational or other needs.
  2. **A Permanent family** - which is reasonably sure of staying in the same place for a long time. This factor should be considered while making decision to rent or own a house.
- **Cost of living:** The cost of living in a particular area should be taken into account while deciding on the locality of the house.
- **Cost of building:** The financial status of the family should be considered while selecting a house.

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